



THE MINING WATCH

Special Report | Mine Subsidence & Ground Instability in India



Part of an abandoned coal mine collapsed during alleged illegal mining. Four people were killed and four others injured after part of an abandoned coal mine collapsed during “illegal” mining in Jharkhand’s Ramgarh district in the early hours of Saturday, an official said.

The incident happened at the Karma project in Mahua Tangri in Kuju Outpost area.

“Four bodies have been recovered from the accident site, while four injured were rescued,” Sub-Divisional Officer (SDO) of Ramgarh Anurag Kumar Tiwari told PTI.

The deceased were identified as Md Imtiyaz, Rameshwar Manjhi, Wakil Karmali and Nirmal Munda. All of them hailed from nearby villages.



Source : The Indian Express (Jul 3 2026)

Karnataka quarry tragedy: Workers, residents allege safety lapses, buffer norm violations



Workers at the Bengaluru South quarry where seven labourers died Thursday had been working without adequate safety measures and in an area where buffer norms may have been violated, according to officials, survivors, and residents.

Parashurama, an earth mover operator who witnessed the incident, said that there was no chance for anyone to escape as everything happened in a matter of a few seconds. “I was about 15-20 feet away from the accident spot. I was transporting crushed stones from the site when I heard a loud sound. By the time I turned around, everything was over. There were about 15 people at work at that point of time,” he said.



Source: New Indian Express(27 Aug 2026)

Glacier collapse, not earthquake, likely triggered devastating Nepal floods



NEW DELHI: A large glacier collapse near the Nepal-China border in the early hours of August 26 is believed to be the likely cause of the devastating flash floods in Nepal. The collapse, which may have triggered significant ground vibrations equivalent to a 5.2-magnitude earthquake, led to debris flows and floods that killed over 350 people and left thousands missing. However, the exact cause of the glacier's collapse remains unclear.

Initially, scientists at the United States Geological Survey (USGS) recorded ground vibrations resembling an earthquake of



Initially, scientists at the United States Geological Survey (USGS) recorded ground vibrations resembling an earthquake of magnitude 4.4 on August 26 at 8:37 AM (local time). After further examination of data from additional seismic monitoring stations, an analysis of the types of seismic waves, and review of satellite images, the USGS revised its conclusion.

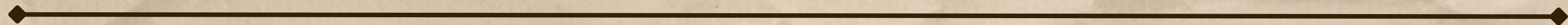
They determined that there was no earthquake; instead, a large mass of glacier or ice had collapsed in the mountains, producing seismic waves that mimicked an earthquake. This event triggered a debris flow, which is a fast-moving mixture of mud, rocks, ice, and water.

The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority of Nepal reported data from Planet Labs, an Earth-imaging company, indicating that a large mass of snow and debris fell after a section of the glacier on the northern side of Langtang Himal detached. This mass dropped from an elevation of nearly 5 km to the river surface at around 3 km.



Conclusions

- Low-cost multi-sensor + ESP32 + LoRa enables real-time, distributed mine-ground monitoring.
 - Risk/anomaly analysis with dashboard and SMS alerts supports faster identification and response to abnormal conditions.
 - The system provides a scalable prototype for early warning, with future scope for field validation and AI/ML-based prediction.
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Thank you

